

November 3, 2025 01:32 AM GMT

Standard Chartered | Asia Pacific

Research Tactical Idea

We believe the share price will rise relative to the industry over the next 30 days.

This is because of an earnings release. Standard Chartered produced a strong set of results, and we have revised up our earnings estimates for 2025/26/27 by 11%/3.5%/2%, respectively. RoTE management guidance was upgraded to ~13% (previously approaching 13%). 2026 update RoTE guidance expected Feb 2026, and new medium-term expectations to be provided in May 2026. We forecast RoTE of 13.1% in 2025. We see RoTE above 14% from 2027 onward.

We estimate that there is about a 70% to 80% (or "very likely") probability for the scenario.

Estimated probabilities are illustrative and assigned subjectively based on our assessment of the likelihood of the scenario.

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Morgan Stanley appreciates your support in the 2026 Extel (ex-Institutional Investor) Asia Research Survey. Voting opens 12 November 2025.

Standard Chartered (2888.HK, 2888 HK)

Hong Kong Financials | Hong Kong

Stock Rating	Overweight
Industry View	In-Line
Price target	HK\$176.70
Shr price, close (Oct 31, 2025)	HK\$157.80
52-Week Range	HK\$160.60-86.25
Sh out, dil, curr (mn)	2,408
Mkt cap, curr (mn)	US\$48,901
EV, curr (mn)	US\$49,627
Avg daily trading value (mn)	HK\$109

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Valuation Methodology and Risks

Standard Chartered (2888.HK)

Gordon Growth model, probability-weighted 20% bull, 70% base, 10% bear (based upon likelihood of different macro outcomes, as well as returns and franchise improvement).

Key assumptions:

- 11% cost of equity base, 10.3% bull, 15.5% bear.
- Return on allocated equity: 10.3% bull, 9% base, 15.5% bear

The result: target P/Bs 2.0x bull, 1.2x base, 0.5x bear.

Risks to Upside

- Faster-than-expected macroeconomic growth and resilience, causing better-than-expected asset quality
- Better-than-expected non-interest income growth
- Rates trough above 3%
- Bank able to return capital sooner than currently expected

Risks to Downside

- Incremental deterioration in asset quality
- Greater pressure on interest rates
- Asian macro climate deteriorates
- Failure to deliver of cost targets

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(as of October 31, 2025)

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Stock Rating Category	Coverage Universe		Investment Banking Clients (IBC)			Other Material Investment Services Clients (MISC)	
	Count	% of Total	Count	% of Total IBC	% of Rating Category	Count	% of Total Other MISC
Overweight/Buy	1501	41%	384	46%	26%	703	41%
Equal-weight/Hold	1609	44%	370	44%	23%	788	46%
Not-Rated/Hold	4	0%	1	0%	25%	1	0%
Underweight/Sell	568	15%	80	10%	14%	223	13%
Total	3,682		835			1715	

Data include common stock and ADRs currently assigned ratings. Investment Banking Clients are companies from whom Morgan Stanley received investment banking compensation in the last 12 months. Due to rounding off of decimals, the percentages provided in the "% of total" column may not add up to exactly 100 percent.

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Overweight (O). The stock's total return is expected to exceed the average total return of the analyst's industry (or industry team's) coverage universe, on a risk-adjusted basis, over the next 12-18 months.

Equal-weight (E). The stock's total return is expected to be in line with the average total return of the analyst's industry (or industry team's) coverage universe, on a risk-adjusted basis, over the next 12-18 months.

Not-Rated (NR). Currently the analyst does not have adequate conviction about the stock's total return relative to the average total return of the analyst's industry (or industry team's) coverage universe, on a risk-adjusted basis, over the next 12-18 months.

Underweight (U). The stock's total return is expected to be below the average total return of the analyst's industry (or industry team's) coverage universe, on a risk-adjusted basis, over the next 12-18 months.

Unless otherwise specified, the time frame for price targets included in Morgan Stanley Research is 12 to 18 months.

Analyst Industry Views

Attractive (A): The analyst expects the performance of his or her industry coverage universe over the next 12-18 months to be attractive vs. the relevant broad market benchmark, as indicated below.

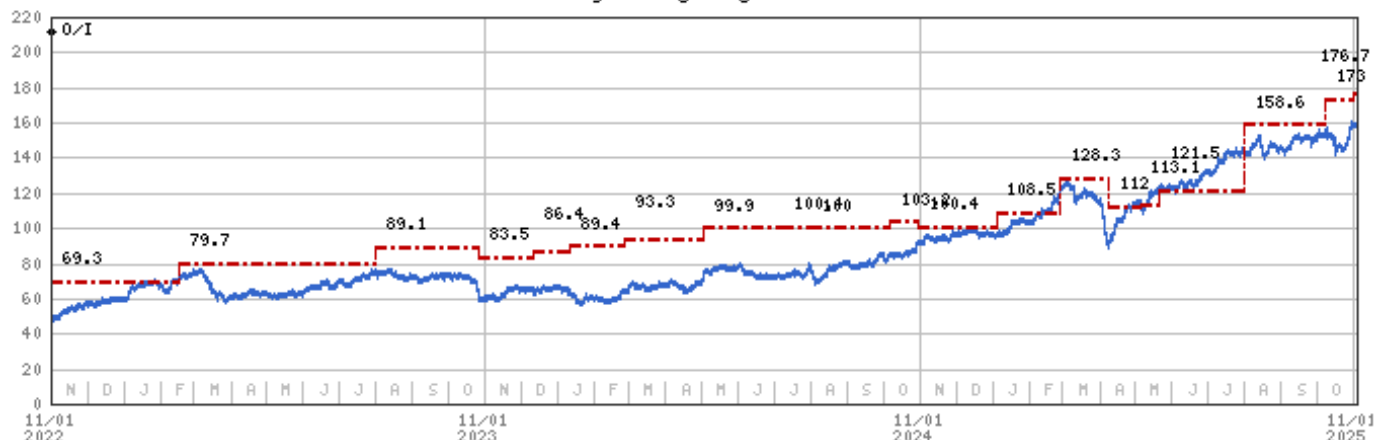
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Stock Price, Price Target and Rating History (See Rating Definitions)

Standard Chartered (2888.HK) - As of 11/03/25 GMT in HKD
Industry : Hong Kong Financials



Stock Rating History: 11/1/20 : E/C; 10/17/22 : 0/I

Price Target History: 10/8/20 : 41; 1/12/21 : 51; 8/11/21 : 52; 2/16/22 : 58.5; 6/8/22 : 61.8; 10/17/22 : 69.3; 2/17/23 : 79.7; 7/31/23 : 89.1; 10/27/23 : 83.5; 12/12/23 : 86.4; 1/11/24 : 89.4; 2/26/24 : 93.3; 5/3/24 : 99.9; 7/8/24 : 100.4; 8/1/24 : 100; 10/7/24 : 103.2; 10/30/24 : 100.4; 1/4/25 : 108.5; 2/27/25 : 128.3; 4/9/25 : 112; 5/5/25 : 113.1; 5/21/25 : 121.5; 8/1/25 : 158.6; 10/8/25 : 173; 10/31/25 : 176.7

Source: Morgan Stanley Research Date Format : MM/DD/YY Price Target --- No Price Target Assigned (NA)

Stock Price (Not Covered by Current Analyst) — Stock Price (Covered by Current Analyst) —

Stock and Industry Ratings (abbreviations below) appear as ★ Stock Rating/Industry View

Stock Ratings: Overweight (O) Equal-weight (E) Underweight (U) Not-Rated (NR) No Rating Available (NA)

Industry View: Attractive (A) In-line (I) Cautious (C) No Rating (NR)

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Nick Lord		
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HSBC Holdings (0005.HK)	++	HK\$108.10
Standard Chartered (2888.HK)	O (10/17/2022)	HK\$157.80
Richard Xu, CFA		
HK Exchanges & Clearing (0388.HK)	O (02/24/2025)	HK\$423.60

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